Incident Investigation Report: Registry Run Key Persistence on DESKTOP-5OG7C28

Report date: 28 October 2026

Host: DESKTOP-5OG7C28 (Wazuh agent 001 "Windows_VM", 192.168.232.130)

Wazuh manager: dcasey-virtual-machine

Account involved: DESKTOP-5OG7C28\Darragh Casey (SID S-1-5-21-2586188580-1629295405-1270050116-1001)

Evidence sources: Scenario_3_Alerts.json (3 Wazuh alerts) and Scenario_3_Archives.json (21 Wazuh archive records: Sysmon Operational, Security and System channels)

Time basis: All times are event times (systemTime/UtcTime) in UTC on 27 October 2026. Wazuh timestamps are manager ingestion times in UTC+01:00 and run about 7.5 to 8.2 seconds behind the event times. They are not used for sequencing.

1. Executive Summary

On 27 October 2026, between 12:05:06.591 and 12:05:07.993 UTC, one elevated PowerShell process (PID 12276) running as the local user Darragh Casey did two things. First, it ran six host and user discovery commands: hostname.exe four times and whoami.exe twice. Second, it launched cmd.exe, which ran reg.exe to write a new value named "Atomic Red Team" into the user's Run key, HKCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run. The value points to C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe. Sysmon Event ID 13 confirms the registry write succeeded. This creates a logon persistence mechanism: Windows will try to start the referenced executable the next time this user logs on.

The whole chain took about 1.4 seconds. Several processes started less than 100 ms apart, which strongly suggests a script or tool rather than manual typing. The supplied data shows no evidence that the referenced executable exists, was created, or ran. It also shows no network activity, no lateral movement, and no credential theft.

Three Wazuh alerts fired. The persistence alert (rule 92302) and the command-shell alert (rule 92052) are supported by the underlying telemetry. The highest-severity alert, rule 92041 (level 10, "Base64-like pattern"), is not supported: the registry data contains no Base64 or obfuscated content. Credential Manager read events from about three minutes earlier were reviewed and assessed as routine, unrelated operating-system activity.

The value name references a publicly known adversary-emulation framework, but that string is chosen by whoever runs the command, so it does not establish benign intent. As instructed, this activity is treated as potentially malicious. Overall confidence that unauthorized-style persistence was established through the process chain described is **high**. Confidence about the origin and intent of the PowerShell session is **low**, because its creation falls outside the supplied data.

2. Scope of Activity

The evidence covers a single Windows endpoint, DESKTOP-5OG7C28, over about three minutes (12:02:05 to 12:05:08 UTC). Within that window, the activity of interest is limited to one account (Darragh Casey), one interactive logon session (Logon ID 0xFCD15), one parent process (powershell.exe, PID 12276), and eight child or grandchild processes. The suspicious actions took about 1.4 seconds.

The supplied evidence supports this scope:

- **Execution:** commands run through PowerShell and cmd.exe.
- **Discovery:** host-name and current-user lookups.
- **Persistence:** one user-level Run key value created.

The supplied evidence does not show the following, so they are outside the supported scope:

- creation or execution of C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe
- any network connection or DNS query
- file creation
- new logons by the actor
- privilege escalation
- credential access
- any activity on other hosts

The record numbers indicate this absence is genuine, not a gap in the export. Sysmon EventRecordIDs 28363 to 28373, Security EventRecordIDs 83539 to 83548, and System EventRecordIDs 4086 to 4087 are each contiguous. So, under the active logging configuration, no other events in those channels were written during the covered period.

Two limits apply. Activity that the Sysmon configuration filters out would not appear. And events before 12:02:05, including how PowerShell PID 12276 was started, are not in the data.

The isolated lab context is noted. The host is a virtual machine on a private 192.168.232.0/24 address and reports to a local Wazuh manager. That context limits likely real-world impact, but it does not change how the activity is classified.

3. Detailed Investigation

3.1 The process chain (observed)

All suspicious processes share a single parent: powershell.exe, PID 12276, ProcessGuid {4b2ce92d-8a8c-6ae0-6206-000000001a00}. It was started with no arguments (ParentCommandLine is just the executable path) and ran as DESKTOP-5OG7C28\Darragh Casey in Logon ID 0xFCD15, terminal session 1. Every child process ran at **High** integrity, so the PowerShell session was elevated (run as administrator).

```
powershell.exe  PID 12276  (High integrity, Darragh Casey, LogonId 0xFCD15)
 ├─ HOSTNAME.EXE  PID 2772   12:05:06.591  CWD C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\S_3\
 ├─ HOSTNAME.EXE  PID 11160  12:05:06.650  CWD ...\Desktop\S_3\
 ├─ HOSTNAME.EXE  PID 1148   12:05:06.715  CWD ...\Desktop\S_3\
 ├─ whoami.exe    PID 8076   12:05:06.747  CWD ...\Desktop\S_3\
 ├─ HOSTNAME.EXE  PID 8600   12:05:07.471  CWD ...\Desktop\S_3\
 ├─ whoami.exe    PID 8176   12:05:07.500  CWD ...\Desktop\S_3\
 └─ cmd.exe       PID 7912   12:05:07.886  CWD C:\Users\DARRAG~1\AppData\Local\Temp\
     └─ reg.exe   PID 2824   12:05:07.953
          └─ [Sysmon EID 13] SetValue  12:05:07.993
             HKU\S-1-5-21-....-1001\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\Atomic Red Team
             = C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe
```

The cmd.exe command line was: `"cmd.exe" /c REG ADD "HKCU\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run" /V "Atomic Red Team" /t REG_SZ /F /D "C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe"`

reg.exe received the same arguments. Sysmon Event ID 13 then recorded the value being set, with the process GUID and PID matching the reg.exe instance. That confirms the write succeeded, not merely that it was attempted.

3.2 Discovery commands (observed and inferred)

Observed: hostname.exe ran four times and whoami.exe twice, all without arguments. These commands print the computer name and the current user's identity.

Inferred: this is host and user context gathering immediately before a persistence action. The repeated runs and the pattern (three hostname, one whoami, then one hostname and one whoami about 0.7 seconds later, then the registry change) look like a tool recording "who and where am I" before and around each action. This is not consistent with someone reading the output and deciding what to do next.

Running whoami without arguments is a common early step after gaining access to a session, but it is also common in legitimate administration. On its own it is low significance. Its significance here comes from what immediately followed it.

3.3 Signs of automation (inferred, medium confidence)

Observed: the start times of consecutive processes were 59 ms, 65 ms and 32 ms apart for the first four, then 724 ms, 29 ms, 386 ms and 67 ms for the remainder.

Inferred: launching separate executables 30 to 65 ms apart cannot reasonably be done by hand. The activity was most likely scripted, either a PowerShell script or a tool running in the PowerShell session.

Two other details support this:

- **The /F flag** on reg.exe suppresses the overwrite confirmation prompt, which is typical of unattended execution.
- **The working directory changed** for the cmd.exe launch. The discovery commands inherited C:\Users\Darragh Casey\Desktop\S_3\, but cmd.exe started in C:\Users\DARRAG~1\AppData\Local\Temp\. The 8.3 short-name form ("DARRAG~1") is how the %TEMP% environment variable usually appears for a profile name containing a space. This suggests the launching code explicitly set the working directory to %TEMP% for that one command, rather than the user typing a cd command.

3.4 What the persistence does (inferred from observed values)

The value was written to the current user's Run key (HKCU, which maps to HKU\S-1-5-21-2586188580-1629295405-1270050116-1001). Windows runs the programs listed there when that user logs on. The persistence therefore triggers at Darragh Casey's next logon, runs with that user's normal (non-elevated) token, and needs no administrative rights to create.

The elevated context of the PowerShell session was therefore not needed for this action. The run key also does not, by itself, give any privilege escalation.

The target path C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe is an unusual, non-standard directory directly under the system drive. The data contains no file-creation event (Sysmon EID 11) for it and no process creation from it. It is unknown whether the file exists. If it does not, the persistence entry is dormant: it will fail at logon, but it stays in place and could be activated later by placing a file at that path. Either way, the registry change itself is real and remains until removed.

3.5 How the PowerShell session originated (inferred, low to medium confidence)

The supplied data does not include the creation of PowerShell PID 12276. However, Sysmon ProcessGuids and LogonGuids embed a creation timestamp in their second and third segments (hex, stored as low and high 16-bit halves of a Unix time). This can be checked against the data itself. cmd.exe's GUID segment "9373-6ae0" decodes to 0x6AE09373 = 1793102707 = 12:05:07 UTC, which matches its recorded start time of 12:05:07.886. The Wazuh event IDs (for example 1793102715) use the same Unix-time base.

Applying the same decoding gives these estimates:

Item	GUID segment	Decoded time (UTC)	Meaning
PowerShell PID 12276	8a8c-6ae0	≈ 27 Oct 2026, 11:27:08	Started about 38 minutes before the suspicious activity

Logon session 0xFCD15 (LogonGuid)	5450-6adb	≈ 23 Oct 2026, 12:34:24	Interactive logon about four days earlier
SYSTEM logon and services.exe	5414-6adb	≈ 23 Oct 2026, 12:33:24	System boot about one minute before the user logon

If correct, the PowerShell session had been open for about 38 minutes. It ran inside a long-standing interactive desktop session, and no new logon occurred around the time of the activity: the Security log, records 83539 to 83548 contiguous, shows only SYSTEM service logons (type 5) in the window, with no type 2, 3 or 10 logons. What happened in PowerShell during those 38 minutes is not visible.

Two Kernel-Power Event ID 566 records show the console session being unlocked at 12:03:53.553 (reason SessionUnlock) and then receiving keyboard or mouse input at 12:04:50.329 (reason InputHid), about 16 seconds before the first discovery command. This indicates someone was interacting with the console just before the activity. That is consistent with a person starting a script from an already-open, elevated PowerShell window. It cannot show who that person was, or whether they were the legitimate account holder.

3.6 Activity reviewed and excluded as unrelated

These records were reviewed and excluded as unrelated. The reasoning matters because one alternative reading would change the conclusions.

Credential Manager reads (Security Event ID 5379, records 83541 to 83546, 12:02:05.948 to 12:02:06.024). Six enumeration operations were made by client process ID 7472, under SYSTEM and under Darragh Casey's logon session 0xFCD57. The targets were Windows Live and Microsoft account token and certificate entries (WindowsLive:(token)/(cert):name=..., WindowsLive:target=virtualapp/didlogical).

Four calls returned 0 credentials with return code 3221226021 (0xC0000225, STATUS_NOT_FOUND). The two lookups of virtualapp/didlogical each returned 1 credential. This is the normal pattern of Windows Microsoft-account and token-broker components checking for cached tokens. It happened about three minutes before the suspicious chain.

Process 7472 does not appear anywhere in the process tree. The logon session differs: 0xFCD57, which is most likely the non-elevated linked half of the user's UAC split-token logon, rather than the elevated 0xFCD15 session used by PowerShell. No Sysmon process-creation event links PID 7472 to the actor.

These events are therefore assessed as routine and are **not** treated as credential access (T1555.004). This cannot be fully excluded, because PID 7472's image is not identified in the data. But nothing positively connects it to the activity.

SYSTEM service logons and special-privilege assignments (Event IDs 4624 type 5 and 4672; records 83539/83540 and 83547/83548). These are generated by services.exe (process 0x328 = PID 808) when services start. The second pair coincides with svchost.exe -k CameraMonitor starting at 12:04:50.376, 47 ms after the InputHid session transition. That is consistent with a service triggered by the session waking. They are benign.

MoUsoCoreWorker.exe (Sysmon record 28363, 12:02:53.350). This was started by svchost.exe -k netsvcs -p -s UsoSvc as SYSTEM. It is the Windows Update orchestrator worker and is benign.

svchost.exe -k CameraMonitor (Sysmon record 28364, 12:04:50.376). This was started by services.exe as SYSTEM, a legitimate service host, and is benign.

3.7 Logging coverage observations (inferred, low to medium confidence)

The third segment of Sysmon ProcessGuids behaves like a per-process sequence counter: bd06, bf06, c006 through c606, then c806. Two values are missing, be06 and c706, even though the Sysmon EventRecordIDs are contiguous. This suggests that two processes received Sysmon GUIDs but were filtered out by the Sysmon configuration rather than lost.

The gap at c706 falls between cmd.exe (c606) and reg.exe (c806). It is most plausibly the conhost.exe console host that cmd.exe would spawn, which is commonly excluded from Sysmon logging. This cannot be confirmed.

Importantly, the continuous sequence from bf06 to c606 shows that no other process was started on the host between the CameraMonitor service start and cmd.exe. That supports the conclusion that the observed tree is complete for that interval.

4. Evidence Analysis

#	Source / record	Key values	Interpretation
E1	Sysmon EID 1, rec 28365	HOSTNAME.EXE PID 2772, parent powershell.exe 12276, user Darragh Casey, Integrity High, LogonId 0xFCD15, CWD ...\Desktop\S_3\	First discovery command; establishes the elevated parent session
E2	Sysmon EID 1, recs 28366, 28367, 28369	HOSTNAME.EXE PIDs 11160, 1148, 8600, same parent and session	Repeated host-name discovery
E3	Sysmon EID 1, recs 28368, 28370	whoami.exe PIDs 8076, 8176, same parent and session	User identity discovery
E4	Sysmon EID 1, rec 28371; Wazuh alert 92052 (level 4)	cmd.exe PID 7912, parent powershell 12276, CommandLine `cmd.exe /c REG ADD "HKCU\...\Run" /V "Atomic Red Team" /t REG_SZ /F /D "C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe"`, CWD %TEMP% (8.3 form)	PowerShell spawning a command shell to run a registry change
E5	Sysmon EID 1, rec 28372; Wazuh alert 92041 (level 10)	reg.exe PID 2824, ProcessGuid ...c806..., parent cmd.exe 7912, same arguments	Registry tool executing the persistence write
E6	Sysmon EID 13, rec 28373; Wazuh alert 92302 (level 6)	EventType SetValue, Image reg.exe PID 2824 (same ProcessGuid as E5), TargetObject HKU\S-1-5-21-…-1001\...\Run\Atomic Red Team, Details C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe, Sysmon RuleName "T1060,RunKey"	Confirms the persistence value was written
E7	Security EID 5379, recs	Client PID 7472, LogonIds 0x3E7 and 0xFCD57, WindowsLive targets, return code	Routine token-cache

E7	Security EID 5379, recs 83541–83546	Client PID 7472, LogonIds 0x3E7 and 0xFCD57, WindowsLive targets, ReturnCode 0xC0000225 ×4, 1 credential ×2	Routine token cache lookups; excluded (section 3.6)
E8	System Kernel-Power EID 566, recs 4086, 4087	Session 27→28 SessionUnlock at 12:03:53.553; 28→30 InputHid at 12:04:50.329	Console unlocked and in use just before the activity
E9	Security EID 4624/4672, recs 83539–83540, 83547–83548	Logon type 5, SYSTEM, services.exe	Service starts; no actor logon in window
E10	Sysmon EID 1, recs 28363, 28364	MoUsoCoreWorker.exe (UsoSvc); svchost -k CameraMonitor	Benign OS processes; excluded

Correlation keys. E1 to E4 are linked by ParentProcessId 12276 and ParentProcessGuid {4b2ce92d-8a8c-6ae0-6206-000000001a00}. E5 is linked to E4 by ParentProcessGuid {4b2ce92d-9373-6ae0-c606-000000001a00}. E6 is linked to E5 by ProcessGuid {4b2ce92d-9373-6ae0-c806-000000001a00} and PID 2824.

E6's SID S-1-5-21-2586188580-1629295405-1270050116-1001 is tied to the account name "Darragh Casey" independently by the Security 5379 records (E7). So the HKCU path in the command line and the HKU\SID path in the registry event refer to the same user hive.

Binary integrity. All four utilities (cmd.exe, reg.exe, hostname.exe, whoami.exe) ran from C:\Windows\System32. Their OriginalFileName and Company (Microsoft Corporation) metadata match the image names, so nothing indicates renamed or masquerading binaries. Recorded hashes are available for verification against known-good references. That verification was not possible from the supplied data alone:

- cmd.exe SHA256 15CD209C995B7D3009C91CA40892D5B8F1FB162F3E5F10716642EA278E8E0D7B
- reg.exe SHA256 EF37663B44AC66920C6F33694DEEA01ACB78AE3F3012884819373FA04C3EB5F0
- hostname.exe SHA256 F8B207720D8673FEB5839DF1E52360F72C2AD2CE9917D5F3DA4F30368DC747C9
- whoami.exe SHA256 23240EF9F8B0A9A324110B1C2331DE31DC1B0E08F5359CB707E51A939AF56CD3

Assessment of each Wazuh alert

Rule 92052, "Windows command prompt started by an abnormal process" (level 4, T1059.003). The underlying event is accurate: powershell.exe did spawn cmd.exe. PowerShell launching cmd.exe is not malicious in itself and is common in administration, so the alert alone proves little. In context it is valid and relevant, because the shell's sole purpose was to write a persistence entry. **Assessment: true positive for the behavior, low standalone significance.**

Rule 92041, "Value added to registry key has Base64-like pattern" (level 10, T1027 and T1112). The underlying reg.exe command line contains a value name ("Atomic Red Team"), a type (REG_SZ) and a plain-text file path ("C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe"). None of these is Base64-encoded or otherwise obfuscated. The rule's matching logic is not visible in the supplied data. On the evidence, the obfuscation claim is a false positive, even though the event it fired on is part of the malicious chain. This alert carries the highest severity of the three while describing the behavior least accurately. **Assessment: false positive for obfuscation; the underlying event is relevant for other reasons.**

Rule 92302, "Registry entry to be executed on next logon was modified using command line application reg.exe" (level 6, T1547.001). It is fully supported by Sysmon EID 13, which confirms a successful SetValue on the Run key by reg.exe. The Sysmon configuration's own tag on this event, "T1060,RunKey", uses the older ATT&CK identifier for registry run keys, which has since been folded into T1547.001. **Assessment: true positive; this is the most significant finding.**

5. Timeline of Events

All times are UTC on 27 October 2026. Rows marked † are context reviewed and assessed as unrelated.

Time (UTC)	Source (record)	Event
≈ 23 Oct, 12:33:24	Inferred from GUIDs	System boot; services.exe started (inference, section 3.5)
≈ 23 Oct, 12:34:24	Inferred from LogonGuid	Darragh Casey interactive logon, session 0xFCD15 (inference)
≈ 11:27:08	Inferred from ProcessGuid	powershell.exe PID 12276 started, elevated (inference)
≈ 11:56:52	Derived from EID 566 duration	Kernel-Power session 27 began (derived from 421.75 s duration)
12:02:05.825	Security 4624 / 4672 (83539, 83540) †	SYSTEM service logon (type 5) by services.exe
12:02:05.948–12:02:06.024	Security 5379 (83541–83546) †	Credential Manager token/cert lookups by PID 7472; routine
12:02:53.350	Sysmon 1 (28363) †	MoUsoCoreWorker.exe started by UsoSvc
12:03:53.553	System 566 (4086)	Session 27→28, reason SessionUnlock: console unlocked
12:04:50.329	System 566 (4087)	Session 28→30, reason InputHid: keyboard/mouse input
12:04:50.375	Security 4624 / 4672 (83547, 83548) †	SYSTEM service logon (type 5)
12:04:50.376	Sysmon 1 (28364) †	svchost.exe -k CameraMonitor started by services.exe
12:05:06.591	Sysmon 1 (28365)	**hostname.exe PID 2772 (parent PowerShell 12276)**: start of suspicious activity
12:05:06.650	Sysmon 1 (28366)	hostname.exe PID 11160
12:05:06.715	Sysmon 1 (28367)	hostname.exe PID 1148
12:05:06.747	Sysmon 1 (28368)	whoami.exe PID 8076
12:05:07.471	Sysmon 1 (28369)	hostname.exe PID 8600

12:05:07.500	Sysmon 1 (28370)	whoami.exe PID 8176
12:05:07.886	Sysmon 1 (28371); Wazuh 92052	**cmd.exe PID 7912 /c REG ADD ...\Run /V "Atomic Red Team" ... /F**
12:05:07.953	Sysmon 1 (28372); Wazuh 92041	**reg.exe PID 2824 launched by cmd.exe 7912**
12:05:07.993	Sysmon 13 (28373); Wazuh 92302	**Run value "Atomic Red Team" = C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe set**: persistence established
12:05:15.485–15.494 (+01:00 ingestion)	Wazuh manager	Alerts 92052, 92041, 92302 generated (each firedtimes 1)

6. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique	Support	Evidence and reasoning
Execution	T1059.001 Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell	Supported (medium)	powershell.exe PID 12276 is the parent of every suspicious process (E1–E4). Script content was not logged (no script-block events), so PowerShell's role as the execution host is inferred from the parent/child relationships.
Execution	T1059.003 Command and Scripting Interpreter: Windows Command Shell	Supported (high)	cmd.exe /c used to run REG ADD (E4); Wazuh 92052.
Discovery	T1082 System Information Discovery	Supported (high for execution, medium for intent)	hostname.exe run four times (E1, E2). The purpose is inferred from the tool's function and its position just before persistence.
Discovery	T1033 System Owner/User Discovery	Supported (high for execution, medium for intent)	whoami.exe run twice (E3).
Persistence	T1547.001 Boot or Logon Autostart Execution: Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder	Supported (high)	Sysmon EID 13 SetValue on HKU\<SID>\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Run\Atomic Red Team = C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe (E6); Wazuh 92302.
Defense Evasion	T1112 Modify Registry	Partially supported (low)	A registry modification is observed (E5, E6), but nothing suggests it was done to evade defenses. T1547.001 is the more precise mapping; T1112 is listed only because the registry was directly modified.

Mappings proposed by alerts but **not supported** by the evidence:

T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information (Wazuh 92041). No Base64 or other encoded content exists in the command line or registry data.

Privilege Escalation tactic (listed by Wazuh rule 92302 alongside Persistence). A Run value in the current user's hive executes with that same user's normal privileges at logon. No escalation took place. The process was already elevated, and that elevation existed before the observed activity.

T1555.004 Credential Stores: Windows Credential Manager. The Event ID 5379 records were considered and rejected, as explained in section 3.6.

7. Overall Investigation Conclusion

Observed facts. An elevated PowerShell process (PID 12276), running as the local user Darragh Casey in an existing interactive session on DESKTOP-5OG7C28, launched six discovery commands (hostname.exe ×4, whoami.exe ×2). It then launched cmd.exe, which ran reg.exe to create the value "Atomic Red Team" under the user's HKCU Run key, pointing to C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe. Sysmon confirms the value was written at 12:05:07.993 UTC. The entire sequence took about 1.4 seconds.

Under the active logging configuration, no file creation, process execution from the target path, network connection, DNS query, new logon, or activity from other processes was recorded during the window. All Windows utilities ran from their legitimate System32 locations with matching metadata.

Inferences. The execution was scripted or tool-driven rather than typed by hand, based on the sub-100 ms process spacing, the /F flag, and the programmatically set %TEMP% working directory (medium confidence). The discovery commands served to orient the operator before establishing persistence (medium confidence). The PowerShell session had been open for about 38 minutes, and someone was physically or virtually at the console shortly before the activity (low to medium confidence, from GUID decoding and Kernel-Power events). The earlier Credential Manager reads and service events are routine and unrelated (medium to high confidence).

Significance. Treated as hostile, this represents an actor with code execution in an elevated session who has established logon persistence for the user Darragh Casey. The persistence is currently confirmed only as a registry entry. Its practical effect depends on whether C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe exists or is placed there later, and it would trigger at the user's next logon.

The behavior pattern of discovery followed immediately by Run-key persistence matches common post-compromise tradecraft. The value name references a publicly known adversary-emulation framework, which is consistent with authorized testing. But it is an attacker-controlled string, gives no assurance of legitimacy, and has not been treated as exculpatory.

Investigative gaps. These gaps limit the conclusions:

- how PowerShell PID 12276 was started, and what it did before 12:05:06

- whether C:\Path\AtomicRedTeam.exe exists, and its contents
- the image behind PID 7472
- the contents of the Desktop\S_3 working directory

Appropriate next steps would be to:

- remove the Run value and check for C:\Path\
- review PowerShell history and script-block logging, plus Sysmon data for PID 12276's creation (around 11:27 UTC)
- hunt for other autostart entries
- confirm with the account owner whether the activity was authorized
- review Wazuh rule 92041, whose level-10 obfuscation alert fired without supporting evidence

Overall confidence: High. Confidence is high that the described process chain occurred and successfully created registry Run-key persistence for the Darragh Casey account. It is medium for the automation and discovery-intent characterization, and low for who or what originated the PowerShell session and their intent, which lie outside the supplied evidence.